PassFrame
TUITION

The Secret Life of Bees

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Non-fiction (Nature)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Inside every beehive lives a tiny, tireless community of thousands of bees, each one working for the good of the whole hive rather than for itself. At the centre of it all is the queen bee, the only bee able to lay eggs, who can produce up to 2,000 eggs in a single day.

Worker bees — all of them female — spend their short lives on an extraordinary variety of jobs. Some clean and guard the hive, some care for the young, and others fly out to collect nectar and pollen from flowers, sometimes travelling over eight kilometres in a single journey.

Perhaps the most astonishing thing about bees is how they communicate. When a worker bee discovers a good source of flowers, she returns to the hive and performs a special movement called the waggle dance, wiggling her body in a particular pattern to tell the other bees exactly where the flowers are and how far away they lie.

As bees travel from flower to flower collecting nectar, tiny grains of pollen stick to the hairs on their legs and bodies. Without realising it, the bees carry this pollen from one flower to the next, allowing plants to produce seeds and fruit — a process called pollination that much of our food supply depends upon.

Scientists estimate that roughly one in every three mouthfuls of food we eat exists only because of pollinators like bees. Without these small, hardworking insects, our fields, orchards and gardens would look very different indeed.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. How many eggs can a queen bee lay in a single day?

2. What three jobs does the text say worker bees do inside the hive?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you how far worker bees sometimes travel to collect nectar.

4. Underline the sentence that explains what the waggle dance is used for.

5. What does “astonishing” suggest about how the author views bee communication?

6. True or false: male bees do most of the work inside the hive.

7. Why do you think bees developed a “dance” to communicate, rather than another method?

8. What happens to pollen as bees travel from flower to flower?

9. In your own words, explain what pollination is and why it matters.

10. What does the final statistic about “one in every three mouthfuls” suggest about how important bees are?

11. Why do you think the author chose to end the extract with a fact about our food supply?

12. Do you think more should be done to protect bees? Explain your opinion using evidence from the text.